

Summary of Supported Employment, Non-Work, and Related Services within Medicaid Waivers Supporting Adults with IDD

Project Summary

What is the problem?

The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) has clarified that individual competitive employment is the preferred outcome of employment supports offered within Home and Community-Based Services (CMS, 2011, 2014). However, while people with IDD want to work and employers want to hire, state IDD agency funding strategies do not consistently support long-term growth in integrated employment, and state IDD agency investment in integrated employment varies widely across states (SELN, 2015; Winsor et al., in press). Research has found that a determining factor is how state IDD agencies structure the contracting and payment rates for employment and day services and that there are a series of key assumptions that underlie successful funding structures (Winsor et al., 2017).

What is the solution?

The goal of the three-year project is to address the relationship between the structure and delivery of funding for employment support and employment outcomes to IDD agency employment and day service recipients who receive an integrated employment service. The Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston (ICI) and the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services (NASDDDS) have partnered to address gaps in employment supports and outcomes for people with IDD through a focus on how employment services and supports are funded by state IDD agencies.

How will researchers approach this solution?

In stage 1 of the project, researchers at the ICI will:

- » catalogue state IDD agency employment service contracting methods and service payment rates for each of the 50 states and the District of Columbia to describe and categorize financing policy
- » summarize data from Medicaid waivers (1915c, l, j, and k) under the authority of state IDD agencies that serve individuals with IDD and related conditions by state, waiver name, and service type, which includes supported integrated employment, pre-vocational services, day habilitation services, and other services that can support employment and community engagement (researchers will only include waivers that have been approved by CMS [as noted on the CMS website](#)).



In stage 2 of the project, ICI researchers will:

- » use the catalog to conduct quantitative analyses to identify predictive variables that lead to better employment outcomes
- » compare variables from the catalog of state IDD waivers to outcome measures from datasets, including the ICI's National Survey of State Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities Agencies' Employment and Day Services, the American Community Survey, and the National Core Indicator Project

In stage 3 of the project, ICI researchers will:

develop a framework to help guide state IDD agencies and Medicaid Authorities with best practices for:

- » creating financing structures that prioritize integrated employment outcomes for people with IDD
- » developing contracting and payment methods for increasing employment outcomes for people with IDD
- » incorporating remote services and assistive technology into funding and contracting methods, with a focus on individual and family needs

Table 1 describes the sample of waivers, Table 2 describes the number of different service types provided by each state, and Table 3 describes the number of states that include a remote support or non-medical transportation service within their waivers.

Table 1. Sample of Waivers

Sample size	51
Total number of waivers coded	101
Total number of supported integrated employment services across the sample	204
Total number of pre-vocational and day services across the sample	236

Table 2. Number of Different Service Types Provided by Each State

State	Number of Waivers	Number of Supported Integrated Employment Services	Number of Day Services
Alaska	3	3	3
Alabama	3	15	14
Arizona	1	5	0
Arkansas	2	1	6
California	2	2	6
Colorado	2	2	5
Connecticut	4	13	12
District of Columbia	2	2	3
Delaware	1	2	3
Florida	1	1	2
Georgia	2	2	4
Hawaii	1	1	3
Indiana	1	1	2
Illinois	1	2	2
Indiana	2	2	6
Iowa	1	1	3
Kansas	1	1	1
Kentucky	2	2	4
Louisiana	3	3	9
Massachusetts	3	5	9
Maryland	2	6	4
Maine	3	11	4
Michigan	1	1	2
Minnesota	1	3	4
Missouri	3	12	12
Mississippi	1	4	2
Montana	1	4	1
North Carolina	1	1	1
North Dakota	1	1	1
Nebraska	2	5	6
New Hampshire	1	1	3
New Mexico	3	3	5
Nevada	1	2	2
New York	1	2	3
Ohio	3	9	6
Oklahoma	3	3	9
Oregon	1	3	1
Pennsylvania	5	15	12
Rhode Island	1	3	1
South Carolina	2	2	8
South Dakota	2	2	2
Tennessee	3	3	5
Texas	3	6	6
Utah	3	3	6
Vermont	1	1	1
Virginia	3	8	12
Washington	5	5	4
Wisconsin	2	6	6
West Virginia	1	2	2
Wyoming	2	2	4
Wisconsin	1	3	2

Table 3. Number of States That Include a Remote Support or Non-Medical Transportation Service Within Their Waivers

State	Is remote support included as a unique service type?	If yes, in how many waivers?	Is non-medical transportation included as a unique service type?	If yes, in how many waivers?
Alaska	Yes	3	No	
Alabama	Yes	3	No	
Arizona	No			
Arkansas	No		No	
California	Yes	2	No	
Colorado	Yes	2	No	
Connecticut	Yes	3	Yes	3
District of Columbia	No		No	
Delaware	No		No	
Florida	No		No	
Georgia	Yes	2	No	
Hawaii	No		No	
Idaho	Yes	1	No	
Illinois	Yes	1	Yes	1
Indiana	Yes	2	No	
Iowa	No		Yes	1
Kansas	No		No	
Kentucky	Yes	2	No	
Louisiana	Yes	1	No	
Massachusetts	Yes	3	Yes	2
Maryland	Yes	2	No	
Maine	Yes	3	No	
Michigan	No		No	
Minnesota	Yes	1	No	
Missouri	Yes	3	No	
Mississippi	No		No	
Montana	Yes	1	No	
North Carolina	No		No	
North Dakota	Yes	1	No	
Nebraska	Yes	2	No	
New Hampshire	Yes	1	No	
New Mexico	Yes	2	No	
Nevada	Yes	1	No	
New York	No		No	
Ohio	Yes	3	No	
Oklahoma	Yes	3	Yes	3
Oregon	No		No	
Pennsylvania	Yes	5	Yes	4
Rhode Island	No		Yes	1
South Carolina	No		No	
South Dakota	No		No	
Tennessee	Yes	3	No	
Texas	No		No	
Utah	Yes	3	No	
Vermont	No		Yes	1
Virginia	Yes	3	No	
Washington	Yes	5	Yes	1
Wisconsin	Yes	2	No	
West Virginia	Yes	1	No	
Wyoming	Yes	1	No	
Wisconsin	No		No	

References

- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. (2011). Updates to the §1915 (c) Waiver Instructions and Technical Guide regarding employment and employment related services [Informational bulletin]. U.S. Department of Health & Human Services. <https://downloads.cms.gov/cmsgov/archived-downloads/CMCSBulletins/downloads/CIB-9-16-11.pdf>
- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. (2014). Medicaid program; state plan home and community-based services, 5-year period for waivers, provider payment reassignment, and home and community-based setting requirements for community first choice (Section 1915(k) of the Act) and home and community-based services (HCBS) waivers (Section 1915(c) of the Act). U.S. Department of Health & Human Services. <https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2014-01-16/pdf/2014-00487.pdf>
- Winsor, J., Butterworth, J., & Zalewska, A. (in press). Employment Systems Change for Individuals with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities (IDD) as Measured by use of State IDD Agency Integrated Employment Services.



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